

Tending to Troy

Design System & UX Specification

Version 1.0

Design Philosophy

Tending to Troy should never feel like productivity software.

Instead, it should feel like opening a beautifully kept household journal that lives permanently on the kitchen table.

The emotional response should be one of calm ownership rather than urgency.

Users should enjoy browsing their home rather than clearing a backlog.

The interface should reward slowing down.

Every screen should communicate craftsmanship.

The design should still look beautiful in ten years.

Avoid fashionable UI trends.

Timelessness is the goal.

Emotional Keywords

Warm

Quiet

Crafted

Premium

Natural

Paper

Brass

Wood

Morning Light

Notebook

Home

Visual Inspiration

The interface should draw inspiration from:

Premium notebooks

Fine stationery

Index cards

Architect sketchbooks

High-end cookbook layouts

Wooden writing desks

Printed household ledgers

Notion's simplicity

Apple Human Interface Guidelines

It should NOT resemble:

Jira

Monday

ClickUp

Microsoft Planner

Asana

Corporate SaaS dashboards

Colour System

Application Background

Muted Paper Yellow

HEX

F5E8A8

Purpose

Primary application background.

The colour should resemble lightly aged writing paper.

Never saturated.

Never bright.

Task Cards

Warm Ivory

HEX

FFFDF6

Cards should resemble premium heavyweight paper.

Very subtle shadow.

No visible borders unless necessary.

Primary Text

Deep Navy

HEX

102A43

Used for:

Headings

Navigation

Primary buttons

Icons

Secondary Text

Slate Blue

HEX

5B6C80

Used for:

Descriptions

Metadata

Dates

Weather information

Accent

Muted Brass

HEX

B48A3D

Used sparingly.

Pinned tasks.

Small highlights.

Never large buttons.

Success

Soft Moss

HEX

7E9F79

Checklist ticks.

Completed items.

Warning

Muted Terracotta

HEX

C97A52

Weather warnings.

Delete confirmation.

Nothing else.

Typography

Headings

Preferred

Geist

Alternative

Inter

Weight

600

Spacing

Generous.

Body

Preferred

Source Serif 4

Alternative

Spectral

Weight

Regular

Long notes should feel enjoyable to read.

Interface Labels

Inter Medium

Never use all capitals.

Sentence case throughout.

Corner Radius

Cards

20px

Buttons

14px

Input Fields

14px

Task Images

18px

The application should feel soft.

Avoid sharp edges.

Shadows

Only one shadow style.

Very soft.

Opacity below 10%.

Shadows should separate paper from paper.

Never create floating effects.

Motion

Animations should feel almost invisible.

Cards

180ms

Buttons

120ms

Page transitions

220ms

Pin animation

250ms

No bouncing.

No spring effects.

No dramatic movement.

Home Screen

Top Navigation

Tending to Troy

Small tagline underneath

Care for our home.

Search icon

Profile icon

Below

Four priority groups.

Each group collapsible.

Each group remembers whether it was last opened or closed.

Task Cards

Large title.

Owner chip.

Indoor or Outdoor chip.

Shopping indicator.

Pin icon.

Entire card clickable.

Dragging

Long press.

Lift card gently.

Subtle shadow.

Slide naturally.

Drop into new position.

Priority Sections

Priority One

Pinned tasks

Remaining tasks

Add Task button

Priority Two

Pinned tasks

Remaining tasks

Add Task button

Repeat for Priority Three and Four.

Task Detail

Large title.

Priority selector.

Owner selector.

Indoor or Outdoor selector.

Below

Description

Checklist

Shopping

Links

Notes

History

Everything scrolls vertically.

Nothing hidden inside tabs.

Buttons

Buttons should feel tactile.

Rounded.

Comfortable spacing.

Primary button

Deep Navy

White text

Secondary button

Warm ivory

Deep navy border

Danger button

Terracotta

Used only for deletion.

Forms

Large text fields.

Comfortable spacing.

Auto-save.

No Save button.

Leaving the page automatically saves changes.

Weather Banner

Displayed only for Outdoor tasks.

Small banner.

Rounded corners.

Example



Rain may make this task difficult.

Otherwise

✓

Weather suitable.

Nothing more.

Shopping List

Simple checklist.

Each item:

Name

Optional quantity

Tick box

Future versions will include retailer integration.

Pin Icon

One of the signature interactions.

Small polished brass drawing pin.

Modern skeuomorphic styling.

Not cartoon.

Not glossy.

Subtle metallic lighting.

Pinning animation:

Pin rotates slightly.

Drops into card.

Tiny movement.

No sound.

Archive

Archive icon resembles a premium storage box.

Subtle depth.

Minimal styling.

Empty States

Priority empty

"No tasks here."

Shopping empty

"Nothing to buy."

Links empty

"No links saved."

Search empty

"No matching tasks."

Avoid humour.

Keep wording calm.

Error Messages

Plain English.

Examples

Unable to connect.

Please try again.

Task couldn't be saved.

No technical language.

Iconography

Minimal.

Only where useful.

Preferred icons:

Pin

Shopping basket

Archive

Search

Weather

Link

Everything else should use typography.

Accessibility

Minimum touch target

44px

Support Dynamic Type.

Colour contrast exceeds WCAG AA.

Works one-handed.

Landscape compatible.

Responsive Behaviour

Desktop

Maximum content width.

Centered.

Tablet

Expanded cards.

Phone

Single-column layout.

No horizontal scrolling.

Brand Identity

Logo

Typography only.

No emblem required.

Splash Screen

Muted paper background.

Centered text.

Tending to Troy

Care for our home.

Fade into application.

No loading spinner.

No logo animation.

No unnecessary branding.

The application should feel humble and timeless.

Overall Design Goal

The user should forget they are using software.

The application should instead feel like a carefully designed household notebook that simply happens to live on a phone.